ACRI / AMERICAN CONTINENTAL RAILROAD INC.

THE NEXT AMERICAN RAILWAY NETWORK.

Investor prospectus and corridor development strategy

Passenger rail | Infrastructure ownership | Station-city development



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WORKING TICKER: $ACRI | NOT AN OFFER OF SECURITIES

01 / THE INVESTMENT CASE

Executive summary

A vertically integrated passenger railway and real-estate platform, designed around a small number of high-value corridors rather than an indiscriminate national buildout.

PASSENGER RAIL DEMAND

34.5m

Amtrak FY2025 customer trips; a record, according to Amtrak. [1]

TEXAS SCALE

22m+

Residents across the Texas Triangle region cited by TxDOT. [2]

HIGH-SPEED BENCHMARK

$12bn

Brightline West announced project cost for 218 miles. [3]

Investment proposition

ACRI would develop, own and operate passenger railways while capturing part of the economic value created around its stations. Its assets would include track and right-of-way interests, stations, trains, signalling and power systems, maintenance depots, ticketing, and a portfolio of station-area property.

The company should be built as a network of separately financed project companies. One flagship high-speed corridor would establish the brand and operating system; lower-cost upgrades to existing routes would create earlier service and property opportunities; extensions would proceed only after demand and capital gates have been passed.

Recommended order of development

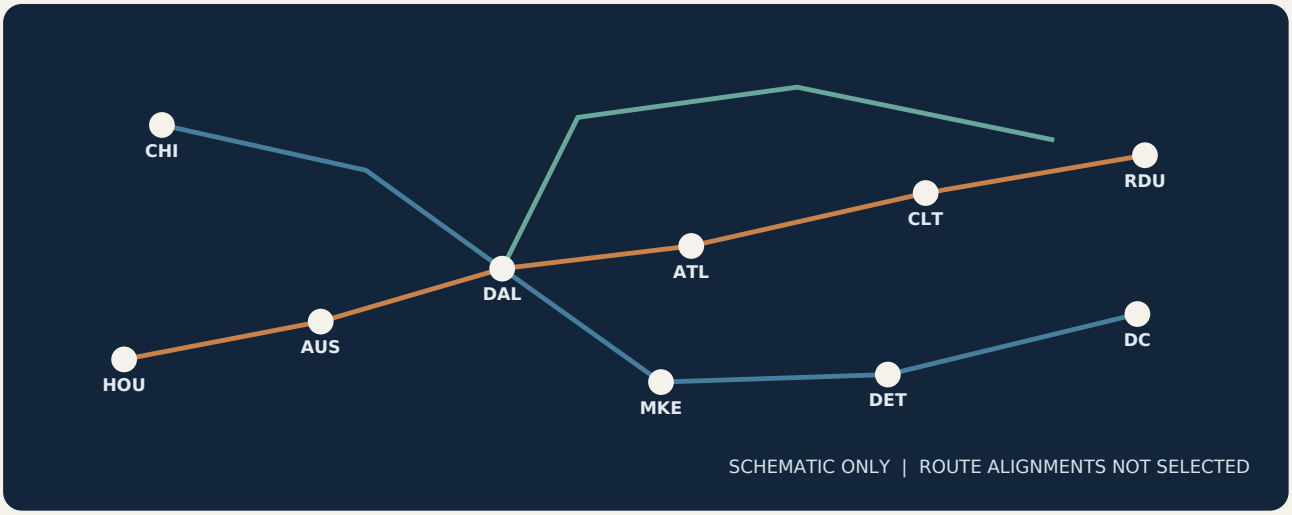
RANK / CORRIDOR	INVESTMENT ROLE	DECISION
1. Dallas–Houston	Flagship greenfield high-speed service; urban terminals plus one or two intermediate growth nodes.	Advance to feasibility and corridor control.
2. Chicago–Milwaukee–Madison / Detroit spokes	Mixed upgrade and selective new-build network; earlier service and station-district opportunities.	Develop as the lower-capital first operating platform.
3. Atlanta–Charlotte, then Raleigh–Richmond	Southeast growth spine with future links to Washington and the Northeast.	Partner with states; do not assume funding is committed.
4. Orlando–Tampa	Florida extension / partnership where corridor rights and station land are achievable.	Proceed only with a credible operating agreement.
5. California / Northeast	Large passenger markets, but expensive and institutionally complex.	Invest through partnerships, capacity upgrades and station development, not an unfinanced parallel system.

Investment reality: U.S. passenger rail can attract significant demand and generate substantial local economic value, but fares alone are unlikely to remunerate a private investor for the full cost of new high-speed infrastructure. ACRI must secure committed public participation where there are public benefits, keep property economics distinct and auditable, and refuse construction starts that fail risk-adjusted returns. Amtrak reported record FY2025 ridership but a negative adjusted operating result, illustrating why passenger growth is not the same as capital profitability. [1]

02 / CORPORATE ARCHITECTURE

Build a railway company, not just a train company

The value proposition depends on coordinated control of the journey, the railway asset and the land around the station.



BUSINESS UNIT	OWNED / CONTROLLED ASSETS	ECONOMIC FUNCTION
ACRI Infrastructure	Right-of-way, track, bridges, power, signalling, dispatch, stations and depots.	Own long-lived infrastructure; collect access, station and concession income where permitted.
ACRI Passenger	Rolling stock, timetable, ticketing, crews, onboard product, brand and customer data.	Fare revenue, memberships, premium cabins, food, luggage and commercial partnerships.
ACRI Land & Cities	Station-area land options, leaseholds, air rights, mixed-use development JVs, parking and retail.	Long-duration rent, development profit and a share of land-value uplift.
ACRI Engineering	Fleet maintenance, track renewal, civil works management, digital twin and asset analytics.	Lower lifecycle costs, service reliability and selective third-party engineering revenue.
ACRI Mobility	Feeder buses, regional connections, micromobility, booking integration and station access.	Increase catchment, yield and passenger retention; reduce first/last-mile friction.

The operating doctrine

- Own bottlenecks, partner where ownership adds little. Prioritise station approaches, dispatch-critical infrastructure, terminal access and station land. Use contractual access or joint ventures for assets where duplication would destroy value.
- Keep each corridor financeable. Infrastructure, passenger operations and property can sit in related subsidiaries, but each must publish standalone returns and arm’s-length transfer prices.
- Build a consistent product. Frequent departures, reliable journey times, simple ticketing, city-centre connectivity, clean interiors, generous luggage capacity and integrated local transport.
- Develop complete station districts. Housing, hotels, offices, retail, public space and local bus links should be planned around stations together, not left as disconnected afterthoughts.

ACRI should not rely on artificial transfer pricing to make a railway look profitable. A credible prospectus shows farebox economics, infrastructure funding, property returns and public benefits separately, then demonstrates how they work together.

03 / MARKET EVIDENCE

What the market evidence actually says

Demand is real, but financial returns depend on construction cost, frequency, time savings and the ability to capture benefits around stations.

Three evidence points

- U.S. rail ridership is recovering and growing. Amtrak recorded 34.5 million customer trips in FY2025, $2.7 billion in adjusted ticket revenue and $3.9 billion in total operating revenue. It also reported adjusted operating earnings of negative $598.4 million. [1]
- The Texas growth market is large and expanding. TxDOT describes the Texas Triangle as home to more than 22 million people and almost 80% of Texas GDP. In the Census Bureau's 2024–25 metro estimates, Houston and Dallas–Fort Worth were the two largest U.S. metro areas by numeric population growth; Atlanta, Charlotte, Austin and San Antonio also appeared in the top ten. [2]
- High-speed construction is capital intensive. Brightline West announced a $12 billion, 218-mile Los Angeles-area–Las Vegas project, an implied headline average of about $55 million per route-mile. That is a useful comparator, not a universal cost rate: urban access, land, structures, utilities, terminals and local conditions can move project costs substantially. [3]

Land value is a second business line - not a magic subsidy

The Federal Transit Administration identifies joint development, special assessments and tax-increment mechanisms as ways to capture part of the value created by transport investment. Its overview says studies have found nearby property-value gains of 30–40% in some cases, and higher gains under ideal conditions; outcomes depend on service quality, zoning, regional demand and the surrounding urban form. ACRI must treat this as context, not a guaranteed uplift forecast. [4]

What follows for ACRI

- Choose city pairs where the train beats the whole door-to-door trip. The target is a useful, predictable 1–3 hour journey, not simply a maximum speed on the open line.
- Frequency is part of the product. A fast train that leaves infrequently or arrives far from the destination is a weaker substitute for driving or flying.
- Buy the right to create value, not a speculative land bank. Land, zoning and station access should be secured only with a viable alignment and a credible plan to serve the places being developed.
- Use public funding transparently. Where a project produces broad economic benefits, public co-investment may be appropriate; it should be committed before construction and not assumed in an investor base case.

Reference note: FY2025 Amtrak figures are reported operating statistics; metro growth figures are Census estimates; project costs and ridership used later in this document are ACRI screening assumptions, not third-party forecasts.

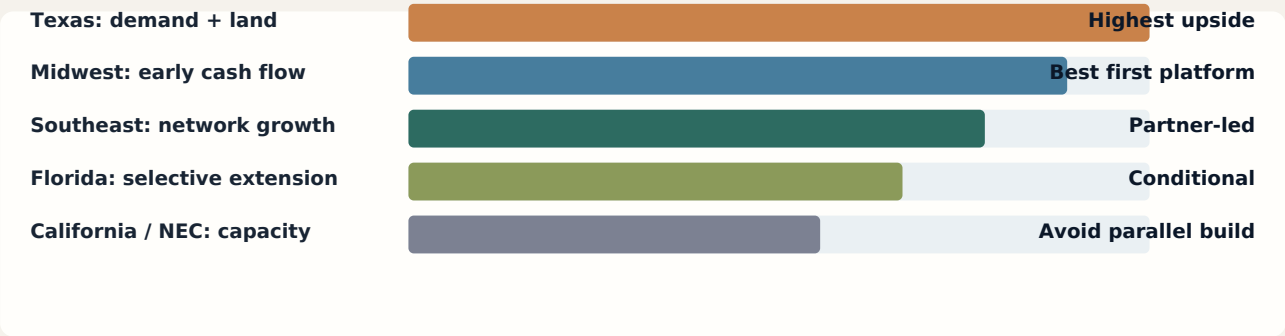
04 / CORRIDOR PRIORITISATION

Where ACRI should build first

The highest-return programme combines one flagship greenfield line with lower-capital corridors and property-intensive station districts.

CORRIDOR	MARKET / LAND ADVANTAGE	DELIVERY RISK	ROLE IN PORTFOLIO	RANK
Dallas–Houston	Two very large Texas metros; growth corridor; potential for new station districts and controlled right-of-way.	High: greenfield build, terminal approaches and property assembly.	Flagship high-speed line.	1 / Adv ance
Chicago–Milwaukee–M adison / Detroit	Multiple city pairs; industrial brownfields and existing rail corridors; network density.	Medium: freight interfaces, station approaches and shared corridors.	Early operating platform and regional hub.	2 / Adv ance
Atlanta–Charlotte	Major metros, highway corridor, future connection to Southeast and Northeast routes.	High: alignment choice, urban access, right-of-way and funding.	Flagship Southeast expansion.	3 / Partner
Raleigh–Richmond	Existing S-Line project structure and regional-growth nodes; potential to improve network connectivity.	Medium-high: multi-agency delivery and capital commitments.	Link in Southeast spine.	4 / Partner
Orlando–Tampa	Florida growth and tourism, with intermediate station-area potential.	Medium-high: corridor access and strong incumbent competition.	Extension or JV only.	5 / Con ditional
California HSR / Northeast Corridor	Very large passenger markets and established rail demand; limited cheap new urban right-of-way.	Very high: complex capital and institutional coordination.	Capacity, terminals, TOD and partnerships.	6 / Sele ctive

Portfolio logic



The ranking is a strategic screen, not a completed feasibility study. It weights population and city-pair demand, travel-time competitiveness, construction intensity, right-of-way availability, station-land optionality and deliverability. ACRI should commission comparable demand, engineering and financial studies before selecting a preferred alignment.

Why not start with the largest possible map?

Network effects matter, but opening multiple expensive corridors simultaneously would multiply schedule, funding and political risks before the company has proven operating performance. Build the network in pieces that each have a credible business case, then let the network improve utilisation of trains, staff, maintenance, ticketing and customer acquisition.

05 / FIRST STRATEGIC CORRIDOR

Flagship: the Texas Triangle

Begin with a Dallas–Houston high-speed connection; preserve a master plan for future Austin and San Antonio links without financing the entire triangle on day one.

Why Texas is the anchor

TxDOT's Texas Triangle planning region includes Dallas–Fort Worth, Houston, Austin and San Antonio and is home to more than 22 million residents. TxDOT describes the region as contributing nearly 80% of the state's GDP and is studying future multimodal needs as it grows. The Census Bureau's 2025 estimates show continued metro growth in Houston, Dallas–Fort Worth, Austin and San Antonio. [2]

Phase 1 concept: Dallas–Houston

ELEMENT	ACRI CONCEPT
Service proposition	Electric high-speed railway; target roughly 90–120 minutes between city-centre stations, subject to alignment and detailed timetable design.
Corridor	Approximately 240 route-miles for screening purposes; final route and station locations remain open.
Station strategy	Downtown terminals at both ends, with no more than one or two intermediate stops unless market analysis demonstrates that added demand outweighs time penalty.
Land strategy	Secure options, leaseholds or JV rights near terminal approaches and selected intermediate stations; phase development around proven demand.
Customer proposition	Frequent departures, straightforward fares, comfortable seating, Wi-Fi, food/coffee, family and business travel options, and feeder links.
Follow-on network	Connect toward Austin and San Antonio only when the Phase 1 operating model, right-of-way and funding gates are met.

Where the property upside lives

- Terminal districts: rail-linked residential, hotel, office and retail projects on controlled land near city-centre access, integrated with local transit.
- Growth-node stations: carefully selected sites in the wider corridor where zoning, road access and local employment can support compact, walkable new communities.
- Railway-adjacent operating land: depots, fleet maintenance, employee training, energy substations and logistics yards should be consolidated where practical to reduce lifetime cost.
- Land discipline: no station-area land is valued as if rezoning and railway access were certain before those permissions are secured.

Texas decision rule

Treat Dallas–Houston as the flagship only if a final demand study demonstrates a durable mode share and the project secures affordable downtown access, major right-of-way interests and a financeable capital stack. The line must be capable of serving intermediate communities without turning an express route into a slow regional train.

06 / GROWTH CORRIDOR

The Southeast spine

Connect Atlanta, Charlotte and Raleigh, then extend north through Richmond toward Washington as operating rights and capital allow.

Atlanta–Charlotte: a strategic new-build opportunity

The Federal Railroad Administration has completed a Tier I Environmental Impact Statement and signed a Record of Decision for the Atlanta–Charlotte passenger corridor. Its study examined three broad approaches: an existing Norfolk Southern / Southern Crescent alignment, the I-85 right-of-way, and a greenfield route. Exact track locations were not finalised in that study, and full construction funding was not identified. [5]

For ACRI, this means that strategic planning exists, but it does not mean that an executable route is already funded. The company should enter through corridor comparison, station planning and state/federal partnership discussions rather than assume immediate shovel-ready delivery.

A practical delivery sequence

STAGE	ACTION	INVESTMENT LOGIC
A. Atlanta–Charlotte	Compare I-85 median, existing railway and greenfield alternatives; protect downtown and airport connectivity.	New-build only where reliability and journey time compensate for higher civil costs.
B. Raleigh–Richmond	Explore integration with the S-Line programme and relevant state rail authorities.	Leverage existing planning and public investment rather than duplicating a public project.
C. Richmond–Washington	Seek capacity, slot, terminal and service partnerships on the established corridor.	Enter the dense Northeast market without proposing a competing parallel alignment.
D. Regional stations	Develop selected interchange / growth nodes with mixed-use plans and feeder services.	Create non-fare income while expanding catchment and increasing station use.

Why the S-Line matters

North Carolina DOT describes the S-Line as a freight corridor linking Richmond and Tampa, and says North Carolina and Virginia are advancing future passenger service. The agencies secured a $1.09 billion federal grant for final design, right-of-way acquisition and construction of the 18-mile Raleigh–Wake Forest section. This is evidence of public planning and commitment to a segment, not a funding guarantee for the full Raleigh–Richmond line. [6]

ACRI’s role

- Operate trains under a clear concession or access agreement; do not assume control of another railroad’s infrastructure.
- Finance stations and passenger-specific improvements where ACRI has durable operating rights and property participation.
- Build frequency and reliability first; speed upgrades should target the slowest segments that dominate end-to-end journey times.
- Position Atlanta–Charlotte as a future through-route, not a single isolated line, but require separate approval for every extension.

07 / DIVERSIFICATION

Other corridors: buy time as well as speed

The Midwest can provide a lower-capital operating platform; Florida is attractive as a selective extension; California and the Northeast call for partnership rather than duplicative construction.

Midwest hub: Chicago–Milwaukee–Madison, with Detroit as a second spoke

A hub centred on Chicago would connect several useful city pairs and support shared fleet, maintenance, marketing and station operations. The commercial approach should mix track and signalling upgrades, selective new passenger infrastructure and targeted station reconstruction, avoiding the assumption that every mile needs a new 200-mph line. The precise programme should follow a segment-by-segment analysis of journey time, capacity, freight conflicts, terminals and operating slots.

- Property thesis: reclaim underused industrial and railway-adjacent brownfields, connect stations to regional transit, and develop apartments, offices, hotels and retail around the passenger interchange.
- Return thesis: shorter corridors can launch more frequent services earlier and create a real-world operating record while ACRI develops a more capital-intensive flagship.

Florida: extend only through access, land and operating agreements

Florida’s population growth and tourism create a potential market for additional intercity rail, but ACRI should not assume that building a parallel railway beside an established private operator is the best use of capital. The priority is a commercial agreement, joint venture or carefully selected extension such as Orlando–Tampa, supported by a defined alignment, service plan and station-area development rights.

California: extraordinary scale, extraordinary exposure

California’s 2025 supplemental high-speed rail update published buildout scenarios including $54.38 billion for San Francisco–Gilroy–Bakersfield and $87.12 billion for San Francisco–Gilroy–Palmdale, each with different funding requirements and assumptions. Those estimates illustrate the scale of commitment, not independent validation of the forecasts or a guaranteed commercial return. [7] ACRI should consider operations, fleet, station districts, last-mile links and project-finance participation only where the contractual rights and risk allocation are attractive.

Northeast Corridor: upgrade the bottlenecks

The Northeast Corridor is one of the strongest existing passenger markets: the Northeast Corridor Commission describes more than 703,000 weekday trips across Amtrak and eight commuter railroads, supported by infrastructure owned by four different parties. [8] ACRI should pursue terminal access, reliability, fleet, service and station-development opportunities there rather than attempt a fully parallel Boston–Washington railway.

Strategic conclusion: prioritise assets that improve network economics or create property rights; do not confuse prestige with investability.

08 / CAPTURING VALUE

The land and station-city strategy

The strongest vertical-integration advantage comes from securing credible development rights around stations, then building places that people actively want to live and work in.

Land types to target

LAND / SITE TYPE	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW ACRI SHOULD CONTROL IT
Underused industrial brownfields	Often near rail infrastructure and utilities; may support large, connected sites.	Options or negotiated acquisitions, environmental diligence, phased remediation and master development JVs.
Exurban growth nodes	Potentially lower entry price and room for integrated districts, but demand is not yet proven.	Secure only a small strategic land position; require local zoning, utilities and anchor demand before large-scale buildout.
Terminal approaches and air rights	Scarce land close to the highest-value passenger interchange.	Own or lease the air rights; coordinate construction and station access under one programme.
Existing railway real estate	Can create value through better access, redevelopment and station renewal.	Joint ventures, long leases or purchase options; maintain railway safety and operating priority.
Depot / power / maintenance land	Critical for reliability and lower operating cost; less exposed to residential market cycles.	Acquire early once the operating plan and engineering footprint are sufficiently mature.

The development model

01 / CONTROL

Options

Secure rights before committing to all land cost.

02 / ENABLE

Zoning

Align utilities, planning, access and local support.

03 / MONETISE

Lease / JV

Build in phases; retain long-term rent where attractive.

Illustrative station district mix

COMPONENT	FUNCTION	FINANCIAL TREATMENT
Residential	Adds daily footfall and supports local station use.	Long-term rental income or phased sell-down; do not count both for the same units.
Office / innovation space	Supports weekday demand and anchors local employers.	Pre-lease key blocks; phase construction to tenant demand.
Hotel / conference	Serves business travel and events; useful near terminals and airports.	Operate with a specialist or use a management contract.
Retail / food / services	Captures passenger spending and makes stations more useful.	Tenant rent and concessions; keep service quality high.
Public realm / feeder access	Ensures the district is walkable and usable without a car.	Treat as enabling capex, with clear public/private responsibilities.

The Federal Transit Administration defines joint development as coordinated transit and non-transit investment and identifies it as a way for transportation owners to capture part of the value created by the service. Local zoning and land-use authorities still control what can be built. [4] ACRI should secure enforceable agreements with local governments instead of underwriting a station district on informal planning expectations.

09 / SCREENING MODEL

Illustrative corridor economics

The following mature-year ranges are internal planning assumptions, not forecasts from Amtrak, FRA, state agencies or any independent traffic study.

All amounts are in 2026 U.S. dollars. Capex covers a screening-level view of track, systems, stations, urban access and rolling stock; actual estimates could differ materially after route engineering. Passenger volumes represent a hypothetical mature year after ramp-up. Average fare assumes revenue retained by ACRI before ancillary income. Rail EBITDA is an illustrative operating surplus before depreciation, interest, taxes and major capital renewals.

CORRIDOR	GROSS RAIL CAPEX	MATURE TRIPS / YR	FARE REV. (BASE)	RAIL EBITDA (BASE)	EBITDA / CAPEX
Dallas–Houston	$16–24bn	8–12m	$0.95bn	$0.37bn	~1.9%
Atlanta–Charlotte	$15–25bn	5–8m	$0.53bn	$0.18bn	~0.9%
Raleigh–Richmond	$5–9bn	3–5m	$0.26bn	$0.09bn	~1.3%
Midwest hub / spokes	$12–20bn	7–12m	$0.52bn	$0.21bn	~1.3%
Orlando–Tampa extension	$5–9bn	3–5m	$0.28bn	$0.12bn	~1.7%

Station property: a separate return stream

CORRIDOR / CLUSTER	ILLUSTRATIVE PROPERTY CAPEX	STABILISED ANNUAL NOI	NOI / PROPERTY CAPEX
Texas stations / districts	$2–5bn	$0.12–0.30bn	~4–8%
Southeast stations / districts	$3–7bn	$0.18–0.42bn	~4–8%
Midwest station portfolio	$1.5–3.5bn	$0.10–0.25bn	~3–10%
Florida station portfolio	$0.8–2.0bn	$0.05–0.12bn	~3–8%

Critical interpretation: the rail-only cash yield in these screening cases is low relative to the cost and risk of a new railway. ACRI should not present rail EBITDA divided by gross construction capital as an equity IRR. Property NOI is also not free profit: it requires additional capex, carries lease-up and market risk, and must be discounted for development timing. A commercially financeable build depends on a lower net private capital burden, public funding for public benefits, value capture and a credible long-term asset value.

10 / CAPITAL DISCIPLINE

How the investment is financed

No construction start should rely on speculative land appreciation or an assumed future grant. Capital must be committed against an agreed scope and risk allocation.

Dallas–Houston: one illustrative sensitivity

CASE	ANNUAL TRIPS	AVG. FARE	ANCILLARY REV.	EBITDA MARGIN	RAIL EBITDA	RAIL EBITDA / CAPEX
Downside	7m	$80	$70m	25%	~$0.16bn	~0.7%
Base	10m	$95	$120m	35%	~$0.37bn	~1.9%
Upside	13m	$105	$180m	40%	~$0.62bn	~3.9%

Sensitivity assumes gross rail capex of $24bn / $20bn / $16bn in the downside / base / upside cases respectively. It is intentionally simple: a final model must include ramp-up, fare mix, service frequency, crew and energy costs, maintenance, insurance, renewal capex, taxes, financing, concession payments and residual value. The upside requires both a stronger passenger outcome and lower construction cost; it should not be used as the base valuation.

Target project capital stack

SOURCE	ILLUSTRATIVE RANGE	CONDITIONS
Committed state / federal capital	25–40%	Only count when formally awarded and appropriated; grant criteria, policy and delivery milestones apply.
Project debt / infrastructure bonds	25–35%	Debt sized to contracted revenues and credible downside case; protect debt service coverage.
ACRI and infrastructure equity	15–25%	Funds development risk, equity reserve and overrun contingency; invested only after decision gates.
Property JV / property debt	10–20%	Finances property-specific assets; non-recourse where possible, with phased release on leasing milestones.
Other sources / partner capital	0–15%	Strategic partner contributions, station-area long leases, utility contributions and other verified value capture.

Non-negotiable finance rules

- No full notice-to-proceed until 100% of the required construction budget plus contingency is covered by committed sources.
- Do not issue long-dated debt against uncontracted station rents or an unapproved development master plan.
- Use independent engineering cost reviews and a reference-class forecast; publish expected cost, schedule and benefit ranges.
- Use staged tenders, fixed-price packages where viable and change-control rules that surface scope changes early.
- Keep the land subsidiary solvent through a property downturn without starving safety-critical railway maintenance.

11 / FROM CORRIDOR CONTROL TO NETWORK EFFECT

A 19-year build programme

ACRI should earn the option to expand through execution: secure the route, prove the customer product, stabilise the first asset, then scale.

PERIOD	PROGRAMME	CAPITAL POSTURE	GATE TO PROCEED
2027–2029	Form operating and property subsidiaries; option strategic land; complete comparative alignments, environmental scoping, demand and engineering work; negotiate public partnerships.	Development capital only; indicative $0.5–1.5bn across corridor development, options, studies and design.	Preferred alignment, documented stakeholder path, credible independent demand and cost range.
2029–2033	Advance Dallas–Houston to bankable design and financing; initiate a lower-cost Midwest operating corridor if rights and service economics are secured.	Project-specific capital; no blanket corporate guarantee for the full network.	Permits, right-of-way control, contingency, committed public contribution and debt commitments.
2033–2038	Deliver first-line service and station district phases; develop Atlanta–Charlotte / Raleigh–Richmond partnerships; build common maintenance and digital systems.	Second-wave infrastructure and phased property capex, released against schedule and leasing evidence.	Opening within approved cost range; service reliability, ridership and cash operating targets met.
2038–2045	Extend Texas and Southeast networks; consider Florida expansion and California participation; add stations only when network benefits exceed time and capex costs.	Expansion through individual project-finance cases, not an automatic master budget.	Positive forward NPV at approved hurdle rate; verified demand and land-use approvals.

Build for repeatability

Standardise platform height, train interfaces, digital ticketing, operating procedures, procurement specifications, maintenance systems and station retail design wherever service and safety requirements permit. Standardisation is one of the few ways a multi-corridor railway can reduce fleet complexity and improve cost control as it grows.

Indicative first five-year workstreams

- Engineering: alignment alternatives, geotechnical surveys, utility mapping, water/flood risk, station access and operations simulation.
- Commercial: passenger origin-destination research, willingness-to-pay, fare elasticity, airline / bus competition and corporate travel commitments.
- Property: station catchments, zoning pathway, utility capacity, environmental liability, tenant demand and staged masterplans.
- Capital: public-benefit case, grant and loan programmes, project debt, independent investor diligence and construction risk transfer.
- Governance: safety management system, transparent procurement, independent cost review, community engagement and public reporting.

12 / WHAT CAN BREAK THE CASE

Investment gates, risks and protections

Large railway projects fail financially when the company commits capital before it knows the alignment, real demand, permissions, funding or delivery cost.

RISK	EARLY WARNING	ACRI CONTROL
Cost escalation	Design maturity stalls; utility conflicts; repeated scope changes; unexplained unit-cost growth.	Independent estimate, contingency, reference-class forecasting, package-level risk transfer and board approval for variance.
Demand below plan	Low corporate bookings, weak reservations, low off-peak loads or high price sensitivity.	Independent market study, phased frequency, dynamic fares, early booking tests and downside case debt sizing.
Land / zoning failure	Unclear access, local opposition, utility capacity gaps or rezoning not secured.	Option first, acquire later; written planning pathway and binding local agreements before major development capex.
Public funding changes	Grant not appropriated, changing criteria or unresolved eligible-cost treatment.	No construction start until full funding is committed; isolate projects and avoid speculative corporate guarantees.
Freight / access conflicts	Unclear dispatch priority, shared-track bottlenecks or unpriced access requirements.	Prefer dedicated passenger capacity where needed; obtain enforceable access and performance agreements.
Property downturn	Slowing pre-leases, higher cap rates, rising construction cost or falling valuations.	Phase projects, diversify use types, maintain liquidity, separate property debt and avoid reliance on early asset sale.
Safety / reliability	Maintenance backlog, missed timetable, incidents or repeat equipment failures.	Independent safety oversight, maintenance reserves, operating simulations and transparent performance metrics.

Mandatory go / no-go checks

GATE	PASS STANDARD
1. Market	Independent demand forecast with fare and mode-share sensitivity; target corridor has a credible path to at least the planning ridership used in underwriting.
2. Route	Preferred alignment and terminal approaches selected; material right-of-way and station control achievable at the modeled cost.
3. Capital	Committed project funding covers construction and contingency; downside debt case remains serviceable.
4. Land	Property development rights, zoning pathway, utilities and access agreed; property income is not counted before lease-up evidence.
5. Returns	Positive forward NPV at the board-approved discount rate, including renewals and residual value; public subsidy is disclosed separately.
6. Delivery	Independent engineer, project director, procurement strategy, schedule baseline and change-control system in place.

13 / CONCLUSION

The proposition to investors

ACRI’s opportunity is to bring American passenger rail into a more integrated business model: reliable transport, infrastructure ownership and station-city development under one accountable platform.

The recommended programme is ambitious but deliberately staged. Dallas–Houston is the flagship candidate because Texas combines scale, population growth and a credible long-term multi-city network thesis. A Chicago-centred Midwest system offers a lower-capital route to operating experience and multi-city demand. Atlanta–Charlotte and the wider Southeast can become the next growth spine if ACRI coordinates with states and existing railway owners. Florida should be entered through a corridor and property agreement; California and the Northeast should be approached selectively through partnerships, bottleneck capacity and station development.

> The strongest long-run advantage is not a single fast train. It is the combination of a trusted passenger service, scarce transport infrastructure, carefully acquired station-area rights and a repeatable way to create useful new districts around that infrastructure. Still, land value cannot compensate for a poor route or a railway that customers do not use. The project economics must stand up before construction.

Investor takeaway

ACRI should be capitalised as a corridor-development platform and scaled as a railway network. It should not be valued as a simple train operator, nor should investors accept property appreciation as a substitute for disciplined railway economics. The first investment decision is not to build all of America; it is to control the right first corridor, prove the product and earn the right to expand.

Sources and external references

[1] Amtrak, “A Year of Records” / FY2025 performance release (Nov. 2025). Reports 34.5m customer trips, $2.7bn adjusted ticket revenue, $3.9bn total operating revenue and adjusted operating earnings of -$598.4m. official source ↗

[2] Texas Department of Transportation, Texas Triangle Multimodal Strategic Plan; and U.S. Census Bureau, Vintage 2025 metro population estimates (released 2026). Population and growth context used in this prospectus. official source ↗

[3] U.S. Department of Transportation, “Approves $2.5 billion in private activity bonds allocation for Brightline West Project” (Jan. 23, 2024); Brightline West project overview. Project cost and route length used only as a comparator. official source ↗

[4] Federal Transit Administration, Joint Development and Value Capture guidance. General principles for transit-oriented development and value capture; reported value uplifts are not ACRI assumptions or guarantees. official source ↗

[5] Federal Railroad Administration, Southeast High-Speed Rail: Atlanta to Charlotte Passenger Rail Corridor. Tier I EIS / Record of Decision and evaluated alignment alternatives. official source ↗

[6] North Carolina Department of Transportation, S-Line Raleigh to Richmond project and project updates. Includes the $1.09bn grant for the Raleigh–Wake Forest section. official source ↗

[7] California High-Speed Rail Authority, 2025 Supplemental Project Update Report (Aug. 2025). Buildout scenarios and stated capital requirements; figures are the Authority’s estimates, not independently verified ACRI estimates. official source ↗

[8] Northeast Corridor Commission, NEC infrastructure and operations overview / FY2025 reporting. Context on daily trips, operating agencies and infrastructure ownership. official source ↗

[9] Federal Railroad Administration, Corridor Identification and Development Program. Programme framework for the national passenger rail planning pipeline. official source ↗

Important notices

This is a conceptual prospectus for a proposed company, for discussion and planning only. American Continental Railroad Inc. and “$ACRI” are treated as the proposed business concept and working ticker; this document does not confirm incorporation, listing or securities registration. It is not an offer or solicitation for securities and is not investment, legal, tax or engineering advice.

Route lengths, costs, ridership, fares, margins, property capex, NOI and capital-stack ranges are preliminary ACRI screening assumptions, not independently validated forecasts. Gross capex and EBITDA alone do not establish investor IRR or enterprise value. Public funding, permits, access agreements and property rights are not guaranteed; investment requires independent diligence and project-level business cases.